

Composing EA 4FM Meditations



How these meditations were built - and how to adapt the method

Each meditation takes one of Alfried Längle's Four Fundamental Motivations (4FMs) and gives the body something concrete to receive. Rather than explaining a prerequisite, we offer an image the listener can rest in - so the motivation is felt, not analysed. The four share one unfolding landscape, so earlier prerequisites stay alive and deepen.

- 1. Begin with the question.** *(Can I be? · Do I like being/living? · May I be myself? · What should I live for?)*
Each motivation answers an existential question Connect with the question as the meditation's aim.
- 2. Name the three prerequisites:**
Every motivation rests on three conditions. These become your beats - one stretch of imagery each.
- 3. Give each prerequisite a body, not a concept:**
Offer a concrete, sensory image the listener can receive rather than an idea to think about.
- 4. Aim at the felt outcome:**
Point the imagery toward what fulfilment feels like for that motivation: trust, joy, self-worth, fulfilment.
- 5. Thread one landscape:** *(Ground → Air → Tree → Seed)*
See if you can build an unfolding scene across all four motivations so the prerequisites accumulate and deepen.
- 6. Spacious use of time, Invite instead of instruct.**
Silence in spacious. Leave room for the listener's own images - your words are an invitation, not a script.

The mapping - prerequisite → image

FM1 · The World - Can I be here?		toward trust & confidence
Support	A downward body scan - feet on the floor, the back held by the chair: "is it possible to receive even more of this support?"	
Space	The breath - cool inhale, warm exhale, the chest expanding: "the space within you becomes present."	
Protection	The skin as a boundary with two sides; clothing as a "second skin" - "a flexible boundary of protection, wherever you go."	
FM2 · Life - Do I like living?		toward joy & harmony
Relationship	Your exhaled breath shared with the living - imagine a tree: "as we breathe, so do the trees."	
Time	Resting under the tree with nothing required of you - "really rest and enjoy this time."	
Closeness	Your back against the trunk, roots beneath you, canopy above - held by a living other.	
FM3 · The Person - May I be myself?		toward self-worth & authenticity
Attention	A café; a close friend who remembered the drink you like - being seen and known.	
Justice	Drawing the tree simply because you can - "it is good and right to spend this time."	
Appreciation	Showing your drawings to the friend - "you captured the personality of this tree."	
FM4 · Meaning - What should I live for?		toward fulfilment & dedication
Field of Activity	Planting the seed in soil, the first watering, a green shoot - "involved in supporting the growth of life itself."	
Structural Context	The grown tree the community gathers under; its roots joining the mycelial network.	
Value to be Realized	"This tree will outlive you" - a future stranger takes its seed and grows a new tree.	

